

A PRIMER ON KRAV MAGA

Sure kung fu and ju-jitsu have mystique and maybe capoeira gets the ladies swinging, but there's nothing as badass as Krav Maga – the no-holds-barred, everything goes, martial art from Israel. Here's an awesome primer for the uninitiated.

<http://dgit.in/kravmga>

HYPERLOOP'S HYPER ISSUES

Elon Musk, the man behind PayPal and Tesla motors, has come up with Hyperloop, a hypothetical mode of high-speed transport that aims to transport people at a speed of over 1000 kmph in an enclosed cylinder cutting terrestrial transportation times.

http://dgit.in/wv_hyprlp

101 ON PRISM

Last month we read about Edward Snowden's brave whistle-blowing act where he spoke about a US spy program PRISM which is targeted at domestic citizens. This Verge story gives you a complete lowdown on what this program is all about along with an infographic on how NSA collects US citizens' data.

http://dgit.in/wv_prsm

THINKING IOT?

We are all aware of the concept of Internet of Things, where future devices will be on the network. But the question that this article tackles is, how will the various connected devices communicate with each other? What will be the protocols? What are the challenges? Read on.

http://dgit.in/wv_iot

Return of the Start Button in Windows 8.1

- Compiled by Paanini Navilekar

Windows 8 saw a tonne of radical changes in the way users interacted with their desktops, with a greater focus on touch-optimized applications. One jarring change that Windows 8 introduced was the removal of the Start Button, an iconic part of the Windows desktop that dates back to Windows 95. Windows users had gotten so used to this little button on the bottom-left corner of their desktop, that its removal led to the ruffling of many feathers. Indeed, developers started coming up with programs that acted as Start Menu replacements, with popular apps like Pokki seeing more than 1.5 Million downloads, as reported by The Verge (<http://dgit.in/l5d5JVt>). Apps like Pokki, Stardock and Vistart attempted to emulate the functionality of the original Windows 7-style start menu, and Microsoft seems to have received the message loud and clear - Windows users want their Start Button back.

Old wine in a new bottle

Microsoft probably thought users were missing the vestigial Start Button in Window 8, but in reality it was the convenience of the Start Menu that users desired. This detail seems to be lost on Microsoft, as they decided to bring back a familiar-looking Start Button in the bottom-left corner that does little more than take users back to the Start Screen - the Windows 8 feature that uses Live Tiles to provide updates and notifications about the weather, calendar appointments, unread emails etc. Users may be slightly pacified with the return of a familiar entity in the screen corner, but its functionality is severely lacking compared to the old Start Menu. Techcrunch

says "Windows 8.1's Start Button Isn't A Start Button" in an article bemoaning the lack of functionality in Microsoft's attempt to restore sanity to the Windows desktop: <http://dgit.in/l35stCw>

One possible addition, feature-wise is that right clicking on the new Start Button will bring up some handy options - among them is the ability to quickly Shut Down / Restart the computer along



with other Power User features. This is, of course, not immediately obvious and is a feature likely to be ignored by the majority of users. BGR goes as far as to call the new Start Button "completely useless" in its scathing review at: <http://dgit.in/l6lDnOR>

Good news for developers

Developers who had worked hard towards creating a Windows 7-like experience by providing Start Menu replacements can probably heave a sigh of relief as the introduction of the new Start Button doesn't render their work obsolete. The developer of Classic Shell, a Start Menu replacement app says "Nobody killed anything", dispel-

ling talk that the newest iteration of Windows will effectively erase the need for any replacement apps. Read more about developers' reactions at PC World at: <http://dgit.in/lbbNbdU>

Everything's not lost

While Microsoft's misguided efforts at duplicating the Start Menu may have failed, it has made some notable improvement to other areas of the desktop. A new Universal Search feature, powered by Bing will now pull in data from local files, settings, Skydrive files, applications and the web. In addition, Skydrive integration in Windows 8.1 is tighter than ever, and Skydrive files and folders are treated as first class citizens in Windows 8.1. Of course, you always have the option of using an alternative like Dropbox or Google Drive, but Skydrive offers 7GB of free space to start with, and syncs more than just your files - your accounts and settings can be synced between Windows installs with the help of your Microsoft account.

Minor changes include the ability to choose any image as the background for the Lock Screen and the Windows 8 Start Screen, the ability to multi-task better with Snap Views that are now more customizable, a revamped Windows Store that makes it easier to find your favourite apps for purchase and a redesigned XboX Music that lets users stream more than 30 Million songs for free from Microsoft's XboX Music Store. One long awaited feature that Windows 8.1 has brought is the ability to boot directly to the classic desktop and skip the 'Metro' interface entirely. Read about some of the other features that Windows 8.1 brings at Extreme Tech's in depth review: <http://dgit.in/l40PrSL>